



8-08-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-Ugb7eVhhDY
Publication Date	2023-08-10T12:51:38Z
Target Category	mcs

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(None)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Board members explicitly referenced or speaking during the meeting include Chuck, Brad, Dia, Eric, Andy, Heidi, Jenny, and Mark. Dr. K (Superintendent) and Brad Jerome (Director of Financial Services / CFO) also present.
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening transcript text, but leading procedural actions.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Superintendent reported on the first day of school, noting smooth registrations and visits to South View and other district buildings alongside Ball State President Burns and his wife. Mentioned the band competition results (2nd place behind Kokomo) and upcoming Muncie Central High School football stadium dedication on August 25th.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Consent agenda approved by voice vote (00:05:58).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:06:09 Resolution: Purple Star Designation for Northside Middle School**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck / Admin team.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to recognize Northside Middle School as a "Purple Star School" to honor military families and students who have served. Muncie Central High School already holds this recognition. Requirements include maintaining a website display, hosting an annual Veterans Day conference, and offering job interviews to immediate family members of veterans.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:08:06).
 - **00:08:16 Presentation & Permission to Advertise: 2024 Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, CFO / Director of Financial Services.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual budget overview following state timelines (Budget hearing scheduled for August 22nd; adoption on September 12th). The total requested spending is approximately \$62.1 million across three main funds: Education Fund (\$39.4 million), Operation Fund (\$11.9 million), and Debt Service Fund (\$10.8 million). Jerome detailed the impact of state tax caps, noting that the district loses approximately \$10.8 million annually to tax caps (ranking 6th in the state for tax cap loss) due to a low industrial tax base and a high concentration of tax-exempt properties (e.g., Ball State University). Board members discussed legislative inequities regarding property tax formulas and reliance on the rainy day fund.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:44:31).
 - **00:44:09 Purchase Order Authorization: Special Education / Activity Buses**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to approve purchase orders for white activity buses equipped with special education lifts due to a 12-to-24-month supply chain lead time. Funded via unrestricted Medicaid funds (~\$680,000 available balance). Following board discussion on supply chain constraints and fleet status, the motion was amended to authorize the purchase of up to two buses.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote for up to two buses (00:48:26).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:05:43](#) <U+2014> Presiding officer noted that no members of the public had signed up for public comment. *(Note: General floor comments from board members occurred later regarding traffic congestion at Muncie Central High School [00:48:46](#)).*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Budget Public Hearing scheduled for August 22nd.
 - Budget Adoption scheduled for September 12th.
 - Muncie Central High School football stadium dedication scheduled for August 25th at 6:30 PM.
 - **Adjournment:** Approved by voice vote ([00:49:13](#)). Time not explicitly stated in transcript.
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